

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK----- X
DARWISH DARWISH,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DETECTIVE HUASCAR MORELL, Shield No.
3801, and NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,Defendants.
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SUMMONS

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of IncidentPlaintiff designates New York
County as the place of trial.

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
June 23, 2023

Yours, etc.

Lara Belkin

Lara Belkin, Esq.

Shulman-Hill, PLLC

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza

15th Floor

New York, New York 10004

(212) 203-1090

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TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DETECTIVE HUASCAR MORELL, Shield No. 3801,

NYPD Midtown South Precinct; 357 West 35th Street, New York, NY 10001

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

----- X

DARWISH DARWISH,

Plaintiff,

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE
DETECTIVE HUASCAR MORELL, Shield No. 3801,
and NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff, DARWISH DARWISH, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his
Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On December 28, 2022, at approximately 7:00 p.m., Plaintiff Darwish Darwish, while lawfully at or around 357 West 35th Street, County of New York, New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest and detention by defendant Police Officers. In addition, Plaintiff was subjected to approximately twenty-four (24) hours of unlawful confinement at NYPD Midtown South Precinct and Manhattan Central Bookings before he was released on his own recognizance. All charges made against the plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety on or around January 26, 2023. Plaintiff was deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802 and his constitutional, common law, and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, detained, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff Darwish Darwish is a resident of the state of New York.

3. New York City Police Detective Huascar Morell, Shield No. 3801, was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. New York City Police Detective Huascar Morell, Shield No. 3801, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

5. New York City Police Detective Huascar Morell, Shield No. 3801, was at all times relevant herein assigned to the NYPD Midtown South Precinct.

6. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

7. Police Officers John Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

8. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

10. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

11. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, Plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on April 13, 2023.

12. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

13. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

14. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

15. On December 28, 2022, at approximately 7:00 p.m., Plaintiff was unlawfully seized and transported to 357 West 35th Street, County of New York, New York, where he was placed under arrest by defendant Police Officers without probable cause or legal justification.

16. On the aforementioned day, Plaintiff had been waiting with his 2 year-old daughter inside his vehicle, a 2022 blue Mercedes G Wagon, which was lawfully parked outside his wife's home, located at 182 Garth Road in Scarsdale, NY.

17. As Plaintiff waited for his wife to pick up their young daughter, an unmarked van pulled in front of his vehicle, and approximately two (2) defendant NYPD officers in plainclothes exited and approached him.

18. Defendant officers ordered the plaintiff to put his hands up, which Plaintiff did, and then the officers proceeded to pull him out of his vehicle.

19. It was at this time that the defendant officers began to arrest Plaintiff, subjecting him to an unlawful pat-down search and tightly restraining him with metal handcuffs.

20. Plaintiff's 2 year-old daughter, who was still sitting in the back of his car, was deeply frightened by defendant officers' actions and crying for her father.

21. No drugs, weapons or other illegal contraband were recovered from Plaintiff's person or from his vehicle.

22. Plaintiff pleaded with defendant officers to let him hold his daughter and calm her down while they waited for his wife to pick her up.

23. Defendant officers refused Plaintiff's request and ignored his sobbing child's cries.

24. After approximately thirty (30) minutes, Plaintiff's wife arrived and took custody of their daughter and defendant officers placed Plaintiff in the unmarked minivan.

25. While Plaintiff waited, in handcuffs, in minivan, another NYPD police vehicle arrived and additional defendant officers emerged with a K-9 unit in tow; defendants then performed a scent inspection on Plaintiff's vehicle.

26. Defendant officers then proceeded to search Plaintiff's vehicle themselves, tearing out panels and seats and causing approximately \$2200 in damages to his vehicle.

27. Again, no drugs, weapons or illegal contraband were recovered from Plaintiff's vehicle.

28. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the defendant police officers have an objective, credible reason to believe that Plaintiff had been violating the law in any way.

29. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, graffiti instruments, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

30. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

31. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested, handcuffed, and subjected to unlawful pat-down search by the defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

32. Plaintiff was thereafter transported to the NYPD Midtown South Precinct

33. Upon his arrival at the Midtown South Precinct, Plaintiff was unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed, and placed in a holding cell.

34. While at the precinct, the plaintiff was interrogated by defendant officers about a robbery that had taken place on or about September 18, 2022.

35. Plaintiff told defendant officers that he had no knowledge of the incident, and in fact had been in Israel at the time of the alleged incident.

36. The following morning, the plaintiff was transported to Manhattan Central Booking, where he was again processed and detained in a holding cell.

37. While Plaintiff was in custody, the defendant police officers provided the New York County District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading, and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

38. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely stated to the New York County District Attorney's Office that Plaintiff was engaged in Grand Larceny.

39. After approximately twenty-four (24) hours in unlawful custody, the plaintiff was arraigned in criminal court, charged with crimes he did not commit, and released on his own recognizance.

40. Due to the false allegations and unlawful arrest in this case, Plaintiff was ordered to appear in federal court for a case in which he had been serving a probationary term with no previous violations.

41. The federal judge presiding over his probation then ordered that he remain on house arrest in New Jersey, where his federal case originated, until the court could determine whether he the New York City arrest was a violation of the terms of his probation.

42. In order to comply with these terms, Plaintiff was forced to rent an apartment in New Jersey at a cost of \$3,000 per month.

43. After passport stamps and other evidence cleared the plaintiff of any possible involvement in these crimes, all charges made against him were dismissed and sealed in their entirety, on or about January 26, 2023.

44. Despite the dismissal in January, the judge presiding over Plaintiff's federal probation did not allow Plaintiff to return to his residence in New York until March of 2023.

45. As a result of this incident and the subsequent court proceedings, Plaintiff missed approximately three-and-a-half months of work and was unable to see his children during the time he was confined in New Jersey.

46. Plaintiff paid approximately \$20,000 out-of-pocket for a private attorney to represent him in these proceedings.

47. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably arresting, confining, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.

48. The unlawful arrest, confinement, and use of excessive force by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain mental and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

49. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

50. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

51. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to Plaintiff by the defendant police officers were unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against him was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by, among other things, seizing and tightly handcuffing him.

52. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

53. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

54. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

55. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

56. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION **Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search**

57. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

58. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and grab employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

59. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

60. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

62. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION **Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:** **Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty**

63. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

64. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely

arrested, falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

65. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Imprisonment

66. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

67. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

68. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

69. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

70. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

71. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

72. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

73. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff.

74. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

75. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

76. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

77. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

79. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

80. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train, and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

81. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

82. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

83. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

84. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

85. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered permanent injury, his liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear for his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

86. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

87. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

88. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

89. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

90. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

91. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

92. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

93. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

94. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

95. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

96. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

97. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

98. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

99. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

100. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

101. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

102. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which he was prosecuted.

103. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

104. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

105. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.

106. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

107. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately twenty-four (24) hours in total.

108. Because of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured mental and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
**Individual Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation
of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

109. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

110. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.

111. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

112. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-802 right against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

113. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

114. Because of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured mental and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
**City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Violation of
Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

126. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

127. Defendant Officers are "covered individuals," as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

128. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.

129. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

130. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

131. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately twenty-four (24) hours in total.

132. Because of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured mental and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

133. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

134. Defendant Officers are “covered individuals,” as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

135. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.

136. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

137. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

138. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8 – 802 rights against unreasonable search and seizure

and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

139. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

140. Because of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured mental and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

115. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

116. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:

- i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of his person and property;
- ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
- iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

117. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered mental, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

118. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer mental, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

119. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

141. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff DARWISH DARWISH demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 801 *et seq.*.

Dated: New York, New York
June 23, 2023

By: Lara Belkin
Lara Belkin, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 203-1090

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DETECTIVE HUASCAR MORELL, Shield No. 3801,
NYPD Midtown South Precinct; 357 West 35th Street, New York, NY 10001

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

LARA BELKIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
June 23, 2023

Lara Belkin
LARA BELKIN, ESQ.